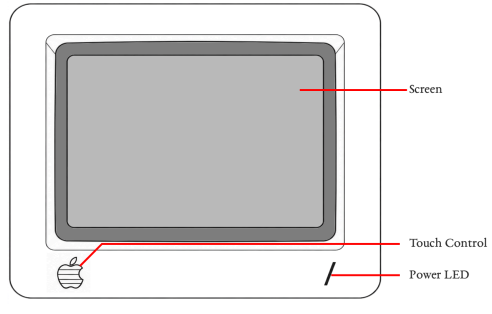
CHAPTER 1

Getting Started

This chapter will help you unpack your Macintosh PiForma, set up its traveling companions, and start the computer. You will also learn how to check a reluctant battery, shut down properly, and return everything to the bag. The packing order is worth a little attention. The foam has opinions.



Set the carrying bag upright on a stable surface and open it. Leave room nearby for each item as you take it out.

Starting up the computer

1. Find the physical power control on the right side and switch the PiForma on.
2. Look for the green light at the front.
3. Listen for a startup chime. Depending on the rear selector's position, there may be no sound.
4. Watch for the startup picture or sequence. The desktop normally follows in about one to two minutes; allow for some variation.

The startup chime

A silent startup does not by itself mean that the computer has failed. Use the green light and display as well as the chime when checking what has happened.

Checking the battery

If nothing happens, check the battery before assuming something has broken. The outside plunger mechanically presses the button on the internal battery pack, showing its charge indicators; the owner reports that pressing it may also wake or enable the pack.

The normal, management-approved way to read the battery is to press the rear battery plunger to turn on its display, then peer through the slits in the top to see the percentage. You do not have to open the compartment for this check.

Unpacking the equipment

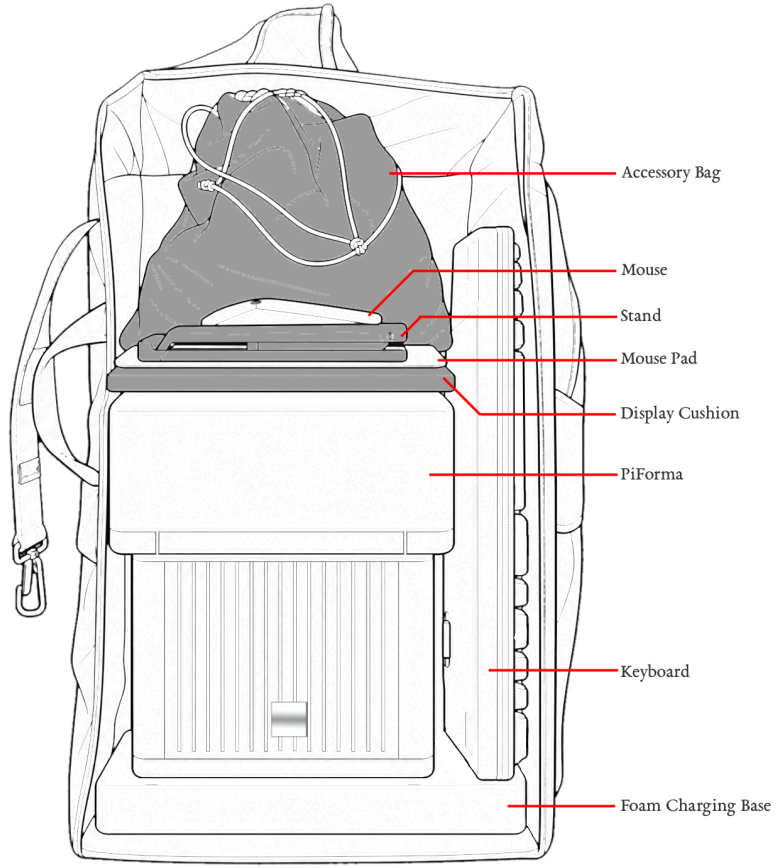


Figure 1-1. Arrangement in the carrying bag. The printed guide is not shown; it lies beneath the mouse and stand, above the mouse pad.

Taking a closer look

Before connecting anything, find the power control on the right side, the green status light at the front, and the chime-selector dial at the back. The Apple logo at the front is also a touch control. It is separate from the physical power switch.

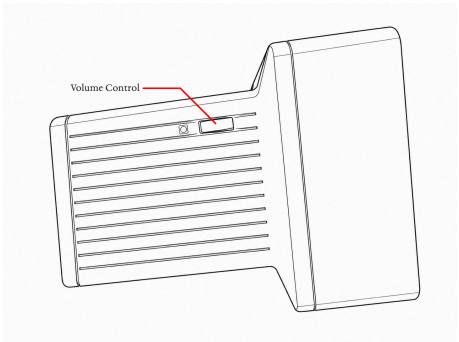


Figure 1-3d. The side volume control.

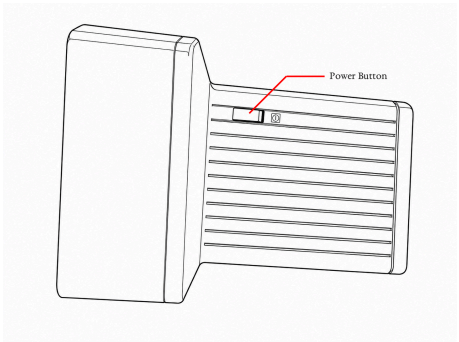
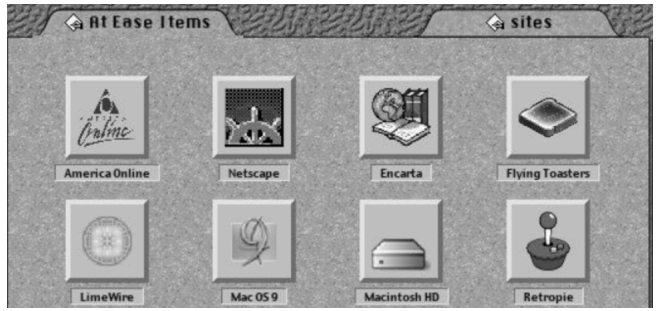


Figure 1-3e. The physical power button on the opposite side. This is separate from the Apple-logo touch control.

Opening programs with AtEase

AtEase

Click an AtEase folder tab to choose a collection, then click a program button once. Allow time for the program to open. A launcher button starts a program; it is not the document you may later create inside it.



Show Desktop

If application windows cover the launcher, choose View → Show Desktop from PiForma Panel. This reveals the desktop without quitting the programs. You can then select another AtEase button. If the launcher is absent rather than covered, see Appendix B.



Technical Information

This appendix summarizes the inspected project records. It is not a wiring plan or a certification. Compare identifying labels and the running configuration before using it as a current-device specification.

Hardware inventory and identification

Donor	Apple IIc Monitor A2M4090, recorded February 1985.
Computer	Raspberry Pi 4 Model B, recorded 4 GB RAM.
Storage	recorded 256 GB microSD.
Display	recorded 9-inch LCD kit, working mode 800 × 480.
Main battery	recorded Anker Prime 26K 300W.
Internal charger	recorded 100W USB-C adapter.
Keyboard	recorded Apple A9M0330 ADB keyboard, BLE conversion, ZMK, USB-C charging, nice!view.
Mouse	recorded Bambu kit electronics in a printed shell, USB receiver.
Startup sound	recorded YS-M3, CK1028 selector, separate salvaged speaker.
Normal sound	recorded internal USB speaker.